■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, August 18, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *San Diego’s famous Wonder Bread factory is getting a surprising new second act*

The Angle: *San Diego’s famous Wonder Bread factory is getting a surprising new second act*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/18/lifestyle/live-nation-to-transform-san-diegos-historic-wonder-bread-factory/

■ *Ticket quotas? State Police Sergeant pushes troopers for “18 traffic stops” per day*

The Angle: *Ticket quotas? State Police Sergeant pushes troopers for “18 traffic stops” per day*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://insideinvestigator.org/ticket-quotas-state-police-sergeant-pushes-troopers-for-18-traffic-stops-per-day/

■ *Remote work benefits are much bigger than a paycheck*

The Angle: *Remote work benefits are much bigger than a paycheck*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thehill.com/opinion/technology/6033665-economic-value-personal-time-salary/

■ *Florida officer used Flock camera database 717 times to track estranged wife's vehicle, affidavit says*

The Angle: *Florida officer used Flock camera database 717 times to track estranged wife's vehicle, affidavit says*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.kvue.com/article/news/nation-world/florida-officer-suspect-charges-flock-cameras-estranged-wife/507-4786ed59-8204-4f37-90ff-2ef3c21ef5a8

■ *The Shock Gloves ICE Wants Are Already Inside 29 Omaha Schools, Used On 2 Students Already*

The Angle: *The Shock Gloves ICE Wants Are Already Inside 29 Omaha Schools, Used On 2 Students Already*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.gadgetreview.com/the-shock-gloves-ice-wants-are-already-inside-29-omaha-schools-used-on-2-students-already

Backup options:

■ *Employers are ghosting college grads and rescinding offers, destroying morale*

The Angle: *Employers are ghosting college grads and rescinding offers, destroying morale*

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sfgate.com/bayarea/article/employers-ghosting-college-grads-22393277.php

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■ *In a new simulation, astrophysicists in the US pitted a 1-megaton nuclear warhead against a 160-meter (525-foot) city-killer asteroid. “We suggest that disruption is highly likely for two of the three scenarios”.*

The Angle: *In a new simulation, astrophysicists in the US pitted a 1-megaton nuclear warhead against a 160-meter (525-foot) city-killer asteroid. “We suggest that disruption is highly likely for two of the three scenarios”.*

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/our-survival-might-one-day-rely-on-nuking-a-city-killer-asteroid-scientists-just-tested-whether-itll-work

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■ *P.E.I. declines Ottawa's offer to let rural employers hire more temporary foreign workers*

The Angle: *P.E.I. declines Ottawa's offer to let rural employers hire more temporary foreign workers*

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/prince-edward-island/pei-rejects-tfw-temporary-measure-9.7309845

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Matthew McConaughey Confessed He Quit Weed After Listening to One Janet Jackson Song 24 Times in a Row*

The Angle: *Matthew McConaughey Confessed He Quit Weed After Listening to One Janet Jackson Song 24 Times in a Row*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fashiontimes.co.uk/matthew-mcconaughey-janet-jackson-marijuana-quit-1762860

■ *Hayden Panettiere ‘Stuck Up for Background Actors When They Were Mistreated’ on ‘Heroes’ Set and ‘Knew Every Crew Members Name’*

The Angle: *Hayden Panettiere ‘Stuck Up for Background Actors When They Were Mistreated’ on ‘Heroes’ Set and ‘Knew Every Crew Members Name’*

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/hayden-panettiere-defended-mistreated-background-actors-heroes-set-1236837264/

■ *Mayor Zohran Mamdani continues listening to New Yorkers by shining off a new helmet to wear cycling after they ask him to wear one for safety. “I’m listening, I’m learning. Safety first NYC.”*

The Angle: *Mayor Zohran Mamdani continues listening to New Yorkers by shining off a new helmet to wear cycling after they ask him to wear one for safety. “I’m listening, I’m learning. Safety first NYC.”*

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/zqngtnzyp5kh1

■ *Ms Rachel: Please listen to the black community, black people don’t hang themselves from trees. There’s been at least seven black people found hanging from trees*

The Angle: *Ms Rachel: Please listen to the black community, black people don’t hang themselves from trees. There’s been at least seven black people found hanging from trees*

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/sftrbliag7kh1

Backup options:

■ *apparently nancy mace is not a fan of people commenting on what she chooses to do with her own body, which is certainly an interesting position for someone who has made policing other people's bodies such a central part of her failed political career*

The Angle: *apparently nancy mace is not a fan of people commenting on what she chooses to do with her own body, which is certainly an interesting position for someone who has made policing other people's bodies such a central part of her failed political career*

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/xo3g4sk0x4kh1.png

■ *Tom Holland poised to make a whopping $100M+ for 'Spider-Man: Brand New Day'*

The Angle: *Tom Holland poised to make a whopping $100M+ for 'Spider-Man: Brand New Day'*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/18/entertainment/tom-hollands-massive-spider-man-brand-new-day-payday-revealed/

■ *Taylor Sheridan reveals fate of long-awaited 'Yellowstone' spinoff '6666'*

The Angle: *Taylor Sheridan reveals fate of long-awaited 'Yellowstone' spinoff '6666'*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/18/entertainment/taylor-sheridan-reveals-fate-of-yellowstone-spinoff-6666/

■ *'The Daily Show' Star Troy Iwata Is the New Shane Hollander in Heated Rivalry Musical Parody - people.com*

The Angle: *'The Daily Show' Star Troy Iwata Is the New Shane Hollander in Heated Rivalry Musical Parody - people.com*

PEOPLE (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/troy-iwata-joins-heated-rivalry-musical-parody-12061922

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Viral De-Flock America campaign urging people to destroy AI cameras on Halloween night gains momentum*

The Angle: *Viral De-Flock America campaign urging people to destroy AI cameras on Halloween night gains momentum*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.dexerto.com/entertainment/flock-camera-controversy-explained-as-viral-halloween-de-flock-campaign-gains-momentum-3399710/

Backup options:

■ *Viral rendering reimagines Santa Monica's Third Street Promenade as lush green shopper's paradise*

The Angle: *Viral rendering reimagines Santa Monica's Third Street Promenade as lush green shopper's paradise*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/18/lifestyle/viral-rendering-reimagines-santa-monicas-third-street-promenade/

■ *TTC People Ink Drawings*

The Angle: *TTC People Ink Drawings*

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/gallery/1vs04va

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Drivers are so used to speeding many ignore posted limits, study finds*

The Angle: *Drivers are so used to speeding many ignore posted limits, study finds*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.freep.com/story/news/local/michigan/2026/08/18/speeding-drivers-traffic-deaths/91350348007/

Backup options:

■ *Study finds GLP1 semaglutide reduced systemic inflammation within weeks, before substantial weight loss, and lowered MACE (major adverse cardiovascular events) risk even without weight loss*

The Angle: *Study finds GLP1 semaglutide reduced systemic inflammation within weeks, before substantial weight loss, and lowered MACE (major adverse cardiovascular events) risk even without weight loss*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ahajournals.org/doi/10.1161/CIRCULATIONAHA.125.074482

■ *Ticks carrying Lyme disease are gaining ground in North Carolina, study finds - WRAL*

The Angle: *Ticks carrying Lyme disease are gaining ground in North Carolina, study finds - WRAL*

WRAL.com (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.wral.com/lifestyles/health/ticks-carrying-lyme-disease-are-gaining-ground-in-nc-study-finds-august-2026/

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *A Finnish town is heating itself with 2,000 tonnes of crushed rock: its giant "sand battery" can cover almost a month of summer heating demand and has cut district heating emissions by 70%, while eliminating oil use and reducing woodchip burning by 60%.*

The Angle: *A Finnish town is heating itself with 2,000 tonnes of crushed rock: its giant "sand battery" can cover almost a month of summer heating demand and has cut district heating emissions by 70%, while eliminating oil use and reducing woodchip burning by 60%.*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cnbc.com/2026/07/25/finland-sand-battery-renewable-energy-storage.html

Backup options:

■ *Man, 31, Rescued Alive After Being Trapped in Underwater Cave for 15 Days Without Food*

The Angle: *Man, 31, Rescued Alive After Being Trapped in Underwater Cave for 15 Days Without Food*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/man-rescued-after-being-trapped-in-underwater-cave-for-15-days-12061101

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Scientists who turned to OnlyFans to fund marmot research receive crypto boost*

The Angle: *Scientists who turned to OnlyFans to fund marmot research receive crypto boost*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2026/aug/18/scientists-onlyfans-marmots-crypto

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■ *White storks have returned to England's Midlands for the first time in more than 600 years, with three birds arriving at a restored Derbyshire wetland that is already home to the county's first beavers in 800 years.*

The Angle: *White storks have returned to England's Midlands for the first time in more than 600 years, with three birds arriving at a restored Derbyshire wetland that is already home to the county's first beavers in 800 years.*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.derbyshirewildlifetrust.org.uk/news/white-storks-historic-return-midlands-takes-flight-derbyshire

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■ *The EU has begun restricting PFAS “forever chemicals” in food packaging across all 27 member states, making everyday items like pizza boxes, bakery paper and takeaway packaging safer for people and reducing chemicals that persist in the environment.*

The Angle: *The EU has begun restricting PFAS “forever chemicals” in food packaging across all 27 member states, making everyday items like pizza boxes, bakery paper and takeaway packaging safer for people and reducing chemicals that persist in the environment.*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://phys.org/news/2026-08-eu-curbs-chemicals-food-packaging.html

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■ *Scientists determine the Great Lakes are nonrenewable*

The Angle: *Scientists determine the Great Lakes are nonrenewable*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.earth.com/earth-science/scientists-determine-the-great-lakes-are-nonrenewable/

■ *Accused murderer boards flight out of U.S. on weekend pass from Virginia mental health facility*

The Angle: *Accused murderer boards flight out of U.S. on weekend pass from Virginia mental health facility*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fox5dc.com/news/accused-murderer-boards-flight-out-u-s-weekend-pass-from-virginia-mental-health-facility

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■ *Babies born under sugar rationing grew into adults with lower cancer risk*

The Angle: *Babies born under sugar rationing grew into adults with lower cancer risk*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://theconversation.com/babies-born-under-sugar-rationing-grew-into-adults-with-lower-cancer-risk-289873

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)
- "NYC women's shelter brings cat fights, junkies and bizarre antics to neighborhood near playground https://t.co/khWuUTWRRt https://t.co/HwXL2" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-13)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 18 banked (+15 each when found)
- "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o " (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Boy George Drops Out of 'Jesus Christ Superstar' After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)
- "'Sunday in the Park with George' Producers Confirm Summer 2027 Show Will Go On 'As Planned' After Ariana Grande Exits" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood's Most-Loved Labels" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Rosie O'Donnell's 'The View' reunion comments spark alumni meltdown over invites" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-08-04)
- "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)
- "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn't Invited to Partake in 'Wizards of Waverly Place' Revival: "Disappointed"" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)
- "Japan commemorates 81st anniversary of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-09)
- "Where to Watch 'Real Housewives Ultimate Girls Trip: Roaring 20th' Anniversary Series Online" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-09)
- "Animal Justice holds one year anniversary rally at St. Joseph's Hospital" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-10)
- ""Roseanne" Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show's Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: 'Words Have Consequences' - Yahoo" (PEOPLE (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-11)
- "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)
- "Chip Gaines Makes Rare Appearance with Wife Joanna on Magnolia Journal's Milestone 10th Anniversary Cover - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "'Cause we (still) rock! The Jonas Brothers introduce a new generation in nostalgia-filled Camp Rock 3 (exclusive)" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "Ugly inning, quiet bats doom Yankees in disappointing loss to Blue Jays" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-14)
- "JENNIE hears the BLINKs, and now, she's sharing regrets from her heart after fans expressed they were feeling let down by the lack of celebr" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-17)
- "Vin Diesel and Meadow Walker arrive to "The Fast and the Furious" 25th Anniversary Screening in LA https://t.co/zDNowKjfdg" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-08-17)

- "JENNIE Offers Heartfelt Apology After Fans Felt ‘Disappointed’ by BLACKPINK’s 10th Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-18)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-08-18 11:37 PM